

Word family: **attach / attaches / attached / attaching / attachment / detachable / detach**

Base word: attach

Forms: attaches, attached, attaching

Related forms: attachment, detachable, detach, detached

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> "...what really makes it special is the feeling **attached** to it."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **attached** means **emotionally connected or associated with the jacket**.

More precisely, the jacket has memories and feelings connected to it, especially memories of the trip.

繁體中文：** **與某物產生情感連結的；依附於某物、與某物聯繫在一起的**

中文翻譯：

> "...the feeling **attached** to it."

「.....真正令它特別的，是**與它連結在一起的那份感情**。」

Here:

feelings attached to something = 與某件事物連繫在一起的情感 / 回憶

1. **attach = fasten or join one thing to another (連接) — 附上；繫上；連接**

This is the central physical meaning.

Meaning: To connect, fasten, or join one thing to another.

Practice 1

> "Please **attach** the label to the package."

「請把標籤**貼 / 附在**包裹上。」

Practice 2

> “The camera can be **attached** to a tripod.”

「相機可以**安裝 / 連接到**三腳架上。」

Practice 3

> “A small tag was **attached** to the bag.”

「袋子上**附着**一個小標籤。」

attach A to B = 把 A 固定、連接或附在 B 上

Common:

- * attach a label
- * attach a cable
- * attach a handle
- * attach something to a wall

2. **attach** = be physically connected to something (本身連接) — 連着 ; 附着

The verb can also describe something being joined naturally or structurally.

Practice 4

> “The balcony **attaches** to the main building.”

「露台與主建築**連接**。」

Practice 5

> “The muscle **attaches** to the bone.”

「肌肉**連接 / 附着於**骨骼。」

attach to = 與某物實際相連或附着

For strict counting, this belongs under Meaning 1.

3. **attach** = add a file/document to a message or document (文件 / 電郵) — 附加 ; 附上

This is an extremely common modern use.

Practice 6

> “I’ve **attached** the report to the email.”

「我已經把報告**附在電郵中**。」

Practice 7

> “Please **attach** a copy of your receipt.”

「請**附上**收據副本。」

attach a file/document = 把檔案或文件加入電郵、申請表、訊息等，讓對方一併收到

Common:

- * attach a file
- * attach a document
- * attached email/file
- * see attached

This is conceptually related to physical attachment but conventional enough to show explicitly.

4. **attach** = associate a feeling, meaning, importance, value, etc. with something (抽象連結)
— 賦予；與.....聯繫

Attach can mean mentally or conceptually connecting an abstract quality with something.

This is very close to your passage.

Practice 8

> “People often **attach** special meaning to old objects.”

「人們常常會**賦予**舊物特別的意義。」

Practice 9

> “She **attaches** great importance to honesty.”

「她非常**重視**誠實。」

Practice 10

> “A lot of emotional value is **attached** to the photograph.”

「那張照片承載着很高的**情感價值**。」

attach something abstract to something = 把意義、價值、責任、重要性或情緒與某事物聯繫起來

Common:

- * attach importance to
- * attach significance to
- * attach value to
- * attach meaning to
- * attach blame to

This is a major figurative branch.

5. **be attached to someone/something** = feel emotionally connected (感情) — 依戀；有感情；捨不得

This is one of the most important modern uses.

Practice 11

> “She is very **attached to** her dog.”

「她非常**依戀**她的狗。」

Practice 12

> “I’ve become quite **attached to** this old jacket.”

「我已經對這件舊外套產生了很深的**感情**。」

Practice 13

> “He was deeply **attached to** his hometown.”

「他對自己的家鄉有很深的**感情 / 眷戀**。」

be attached to = 對某人、動物、地方或物件有強烈情感連結，不容易放下

This is distinct from physical attachment.

6. **attached = connected with a place/organization for a particular purpose (隸屬 / 派駐) — 隸屬；派駐；附屬於**

A person can be **attached to** an organization, department, military unit, embassy, etc., often temporarily.

Practice 14

> “She is currently **attached to** the research department.”

「她目前被**派到 / 隸屬於**研究部門工作。」

Practice 15

> “He was **attached to** the embassy for six months.”

「他被**派駐**大使館六個月。」

be attached to an organization = 為某項工作而被分派、隸屬或暫時配置到某個機構 / 單位

This is a major institutional use.

7. **attach someone to a team/unit = assign them to it (指派) — 派遣；編入**

As an active verb:

Practice 16

> “The officer was **attached** to a special unit.”

「那名警員被**編入 / 派往**一個特別單位。」

Practice 17

> “They **attached** two specialists to the project team.”

「他們把兩名專家**派到**項目團隊協助工作。」

For strict counting, this belongs with Meaning 6.

8. ****attach a condition/restriction = add it as part of an arrangement (條件) — 附加 ; 附帶****

****Attach**** can mean adding a condition, requirement, or restriction to an offer, permission, agreement, etc.

Practice 18

> “The funding comes with several conditions ****attached****.”

「這筆資助****附帶****幾項條件。」

Practice 19

> “No special conditions were ****attached**** to the offer.”

「這項提議沒有****附加****特殊條件。」

****attach a condition = 把某項要求或限制加進協議 / 安排之中****

This belongs conceptually to the broader “add/connect” branch, but it is a very useful abstract construction.

9. ****strings attached = attached conditions/obligations (固定表達) — 附帶條件 ; 另有要求****

Practice 20

> “The money comes with strings ****attached****.”

「這筆錢是有****附帶條件****的。」

Practice 21

> “There were no strings ****attached****.”

「沒有任何****附帶條件 / 額外要求****。」

****with strings attached = 表面上給你某物 , 但其實附帶義務、限制或要求****

This is a fixed idiom, not another core sense.

10. ****attach liability/blame/responsibility to someone (法律 / 正式) — 歸責 ; 使承擔****

In formal and legal language, **attach** can mean that responsibility, liability, or legal consequences become connected to someone or something.

Practice 22

> “Liability may **attach** to the owner.”

「法律責任可能會**落在 / 由該擁有人承擔**。」

Practice 23

> “No blame should be **attached** to the staff.”

「不應把責任**歸咎於**員工。」

attach liability/blame/responsibility = 把法律責任、過錯或責任歸於某人 / 某事

This is an established formal extension of Meaning 4.

11. **attach property/assets legally** (法律專門) — 查封；扣押

In legal usage, **attach** can also mean to seize or place a legal claim over property or assets under court authority.

Practice 24

> “The court ordered the creditor to **attach** the debtor’s assets.”

「法院准許債權人依法**扣押 / 查封**債務人的資產。」

attach property/assets = 依法對財產採取扣押、查封或設定法律控制

This is a genuine but specialist legal sense.

For a general learner database, I would keep it as a **domain extension**, not everyday core.

Related form: **attachment**

Attachment has several major meanings of its own.

attachment = something attached to something else (附件 / 附加裝置)

Practice 25

> “The vacuum cleaner comes with several **attachments**.”

「這部吸塵機附有幾個不同的**配件 / 附件**。」

attachment = 可連接到主要物件上以增加功能的附加部件

attachment = file added to an email/message (電郵附件) — 附件

Practice 26

> “Please open the email **attachment**.”

「請打開電郵**附件**。」

attachment = emotional bond (依戀 / 情感連結)

Practice 27

> “She developed a strong **attachment** to the place.”

「她對這個地方產生了很深的**依戀 / 感情**。」

This corresponds directly to **be attached to**.

attachment = official assignment (派駐 / 借調)

Practice 28

> “He completed a six-month **attachment** with another department.”

「他完成了一次為期六個月的部門**借調 / 派駐**。」

This use is especially common in professional/institutional contexts in some varieties of English.

attachment = legal seizure (法律) — 扣押；查封程序

In law, **attachment** can refer to the legal process/order by which property is seized or secured.

This is a specialist extension aligned with Meaning 11.

Related form: **detach**

Detach means to separate something that was attached.

Practice 29

> “**Detach** the form and return it.”

「請把表格**撕下 / 分開**後交回。」

Practice 30

> “The cable can be easily **detached**.”

「這條電纜很容易**拆下來**。」

detach = 把原本連接在一起的東西分開

Related form: **detached**

Detached has two especially useful meanings.

physically separate

> “a detached house”

「獨立屋」

emotionally uninvolved

> “He sounded calm and detached.”

「他聽起來冷靜而**超然 / 情感抽離**。」

This second sense has developed considerably and deserves its own mapping when targeted.

Related form: **detachable**

Detachable means designed so that it can be removed.

Practice 31

> “The jacket has a **detachable** hood.”

「這件外套有一個**可拆式**帽子。」

detachable = 可以拆下、分離的

Important distinction: **attach** vs **connect**

connect

is broad and emphasizes establishing a link.

attach

often emphasizes joining one thing **onto** another.

> connect two computers

> attach a label to a box

They overlap in physical/technical contexts.

Important distinction: **attach** vs **add**

add

means include something extra.

attach

often means physically or formally link that extra thing to something else.

> add a paragraph

> attach a document

Important distinction: **attach** vs **fasten**

fasten

emphasizes securing something so that it stays in place.

attach

emphasizes creating the connection.

> fasten your seat belt

> attach the strap to the bag

Important distinction: **attach** vs **stick**

stick

often implies adhesive contact.

attach

does not specify how the connection is made.

> stick the note to the wall

> attach the note to the form

Important distinction: **attached** vs **connected**

connected

can mean any kind of relationship/link.

attached

often suggests:

* physical fastening

* emotional bond

* institutional assignment

So:

> emotionally attached

is much more natural than:

> emotionally connected

when emphasizing affection/reluctance to let go.

Important distinction: **attached** vs **associated**

associated with

means mentally, socially, statistically, or conceptually linked.

attached to

can suggest a more direct or formal connection.

> a risk associated with smoking

> importance attached to education

Different typical collocations.

Important distinction: **attached** vs **dependent**

attached

= emotionally connected

dependent

= relying on someone/something for support

Someone can be deeply attached to another person without being dependent on them.

Important distinction: **attached** vs **sentimental**

attached

describes the emotional bond.

sentimental

describes feelings strongly influenced by personal memories or emotional associations.

- > attached to an old jacket
- > sentimental value of an old jacket

These two concepts overlap strongly in your passage but are not identical.

Grammar note: **attach A to B**

The normal physical/abstract pattern is:

- > **attach A to B**

Examples:

- > attach a file to an email
- > attach a label to a parcel
- > attach importance to something

Not usually:

- > attach A with B

Grammar note: **be attached to**

This can mean three very different things:

Physical

- > “The cable is attached to the wall.”

「電纜固定在牆上。」

Emotional

- > “I am attached to this jacket.”

「我對這件外套有感情。」

Institutional

> “She is attached to the finance department.”

「她隸屬 / 派駐財務部。」

Context determines the meaning.

Grammar note: **attach importance/significance/value to**

This is a particularly important formal pattern.

- > attach importance to education
- > attach significance to the finding
- > attach value to tradition

It means:

> **consider it important/significant/valuable**

Countability note

Attach is a verb.

Attachment changes countability by sense:

Countable physical/device/file

- > an attachment
- > three attachments

Countable/uncountable emotional bond

- > a strong attachment to home
- > emotional attachment

Legal

- > an attachment order

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **attach**
* **attached**
* **attaching**
* **attachment**
* **detach**
* **detached**
* **detachable**

The major semantic sweep gives us:

* physical joining
* file/document addition
* abstract association
* emotional bonding
* organizational assignment
* formal/legal attribution
* legal seizure of property

The key curation rule is not to turn every object into a separate sense. **Attach a label, cable, handle, photo, file** all preserve the broad notion of **joining one thing to another**, while **emotional attachment**, **institutional attachment**, and **legal attachment of property** require more distinct mental concepts.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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attach — physical	把一件東西固定、連接或附在另一件東西上
attach — file/document	把檔案、文件等附加到電郵、表格或訊息中
attach — abstract meaning/value	把重要性、意義、價值、責任等與某事物聯繫起來
be attached to — emotional	對某人、地方、動物或物件產生深厚感情 / 依戀
be attached to — organization	被派駐、借調或隸屬於某機構 / 單位
attach a condition	在提議、安排或協議中附加條件 / 限制
attach liability/blame	正式把責任、過錯或法律後果歸於某人 / 某事
attach property — legal	依法查封、扣押或控制財產；專門法律用法
attachment — device/file	附件、附加部件、電郵附件
attachment — emotional	情感依戀 / 情感連結
detach	把原本連接的東西拆開 / 分離
detachable	可拆卸的

For your original sentence

> "...what really makes it special is the feeling **attached** to it."

The exact meaning is:

attached = 某些感情、回憶和個人意義與這件外套緊密聯繫在一起

So:

> **the feeling attached to it**

= **與它連結在一起的那份感情**

There is an important subtlety here:

> **I am attached to the jacket**

means:

我對這件外套有感情。

But:

> **the feelings attached to the jacket**

means:

與這件外套聯繫在一起的情感 / 回憶。

For your database, I would count **6** genuinely useful core meanings for **attach**:

1. **physically fasten/connect one thing to another**
2. **add a file/document to a message or document**
3. **associate abstract meaning, importance, value, blame, etc. with something**
4. **be emotionally attached to someone/something**
5. **assign/connect a person to an organization or unit**
6. **legal: seize/place a claim over property**

I would keep **attach conditions** under #3, legal responsibility/liability under #3 as a formal extension, and keep **attachment / detach / detached / detachable** as family extensions rather than inflate the base verb count.